/queue

> "Inspect the message input queue: /queue [list|clear|next|help]" (SlashCommandDef, crates/ragent-tui/src/app/state.rs).

Overview

`/queue` inspects and controls the **message input queue** (spec `inputqueue`). While the primary agent is executing, the message-window input field stays editable: each `Enter` appends the submission to a bounded FIFO queue instead of rejecting it with `busy - wait for the current turn to finish`. The oldest queued entry runs automatically at each turn boundary, and a two-digit counter appears before the prompt while entries are pending.

Since the FR-017 amendment, **slash commands are queued the same way**: typing `/status` (or any other slash command) while a turn is executing appends it to the queue instead of being refused, and the queued command runs at the next turn boundary — or immediately via `/queue next`. Because a synchronous command leaves the turn boundary free, a run of consecutive queued commands executes back-to-back rather than stalling behind the first. Bang commands (`!…`) keep their existing busy refusal.

`/queue` is the prompt-side view of the same queue the `Alt+Q` queue-control menu manipulates. It is an optional command: it never mutates the running turn, and `clear`/`next` are safe to run at any time.

Syntax

```
/queue
/queue list
/queue clear
/queue next
/queue help
```

A bare `/queue` behaves as `/queue list`.

Options / Subcommands

Form	Description
`list` (default)	List the queued entries in submission order (oldest first) with the queue depth
`clear`	Empty the queue immediately; the counter disappears
`next`	Dispatch the oldest queued entry now (deferred to the turn boundary while a turn is executing)
`help`	Show the sub-command table and the `Alt+Q` pointer

Examples

List a non-empty queue

```
/queue list
```

```
From: /queue list
```

```
## Input Queue

1. refactor the parser
2. add tests for the new branch

**2 entries queued (oldest first).**
```

Status bar: `queue: 2 entries`.

Empty queue

```
/queue list
```

```
From: /queue list

   The input queue is empty.

Messages typed while the agent is executing are staged here and run in order.
```

Status bar: `queue: list empty`.

Clear the queue

```
/queue clear
```

```
From: /queue clear
[clr] Cleared 2 entries from the input queue.
```

Status bar: `queue: cleared`.

Run the oldest entry

```
/queue next
```

When no turn is executing this dispatches the oldest entry immediately (`queue: next dispatched`); when a turn is still executing the action is deferred to the turn boundary and reports `queue: next deferred` — use `Alt+Q` → `Next` to stop the current turn and run it now.

Output

`list` renders a numbered `## Input Queue` block ending with the count. `clear` and `next` print a one-line `From: /queue …` confirmation. Unknown sub-commands print a `[warn]` line and status `queue: unknown`. Statuses land in the status bar (`queue: list empty`, `queue: cleared`, `queue: next deferred`, and so on).

Related

- `Alt+Q` - the interactive queue-control menu (`Next` / `Stop` / `Clear` / `Show`); `Up`/`Down` move the highlight, `Enter` activates the row, and the `Show` row opens a scrollable queue-entry panel where `Enter` moves an entry toward the front and `Del` removes it
- `/history` - recall previously entered messages (a queued entry is added to history the moment you press `Enter`)
- `TUI-QUICKSTART.md` §4 - the input queue and the ALT-Q menu